READING PART 1

*Read the text. Fill in each gap with **ONE** word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text*

NOAH'S HOLIDAY

This summer, Noah decided to spend his holiday by the sea. He rented a small house near a quiet beach where he could relax and enjoy nature. The **1.** _____ had a big terrace facing the sea, and Noah loved waking up to the sound of the waves. Every morning, Noah walked along the soft sand of the **2.** _____. Sometimes he would take a picnic basket and spend hours sitting on the beach, reading books and watching the sea. Noah also rented a little boat during his stay. He sailed the **3.** _____ into the open sea almost every afternoon. One day, while steering his boat, he spotted a group of playful dolphins jumping out of the water. Watching the **4.** _____ swimming so close made his holiday even more special. In the evenings, Noah visited local restaurants along the shore. These **5.** _____ served fresh dishes made from seafood. Noah loved trying different **6.** _____, especially those with grilled fish and prawns. Sitting near the sea, eating delicious dishes, and listening to the sounds of the waves became his favorite part of the day.

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READING PART 2

*Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used **ONCE** only. There are **TWO** extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.*

A. This museum focuses on contemporary art, featuring works by modern and contemporary artists.
B. This festival celebrates traditional folk music from around the world.
C. This restaurant serves delicious traditional dishes from different regions of the country.
D. This hall hosts performances of classical music, featuring orchestras, chamber ensembles, and soloists performing works by renowned composers.
E. This museum showcases the finest works of art from the country's history, often featuring famous paintings, sculptures, and other pieces representing different artistic periods.
F. While not strictly an art museum, this museum often houses incredible displays of natural beauty.
G. This space hosts concerts by popular rock bands and musicians, creating a high- energy and exciting atmosphere for music fans.
H. This intimate venue offers live jazz performances, showcasing improvisational music and the talents of talented musicians.
I. This gallery often features works by local artists, providing a platform for emerging talent in the community.
J. This store offers a wide variety of books, magazines, and stationery supplies.

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7. This museum displays the most important artworks from the nation's past, often including well-known paintings, sculptures, and pieces from various art movements. It's an excellent place to explore the country's cultural roots.

8. This museum is dedicated to modern and contemporary art, featuring pieces by current artists. You might see paintings, video art, sculptures, or installations that reflect the latest artistic trends.

9. Though not a traditional art museum, this institution showcases nature in artistic ways—featuring things like dinosaur fossils and butterfly exhibits. It offers a unique view of beauty through the lens of the natural world.

10. This gallery highlights the work of emerging local artists, giving them a chance to share their talent. It's a wonderful space for discovering new creators and supporting the local art community.

11. This concert hall presents classical performances, including orchestras, chamber groups, and soloists playing famous compositions. The setting is elegant and refined, creating a sophisticated musical atmosphere.

12. This cozy venue hosts live jazz shows, featuring talented musicians who play improvised music. It offers a relaxed vibe, with food and drinks available, perfect for an enjoyable night out.

13. This venue is known for live rock music, hosting well-known bands and artists. The energy is high, the music is loud, and the crowd is lively, making it an exciting spot for music lovers.

14. This festival celebrates folk traditions from different cultures around the world. It features musicians performing traditional songs and instruments, creating a colorful, cultural celebration.

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READING PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A WORLD OF ENTERTAINMENT

A) Musical performance	**E)** Film for all ages
B) Attractive landscape	**F)** Exciting hobby
C) Perfect holidays	**G)** Colourful festival
D) Portrait of a girl	**H)** Interesting book

15. This is a full-length (ninety minutes) cartoon, which is entertaining for both adults and children over six. The animation and colour are of very high quality and the story has lots of fun and excitement. The plot is quick moving and full of surprises. There's romance, action, comedy, music and lots of fantastic songs and dances.

16. This is a full-blooded magnificently written portrait of history's most fascinating woman. Readers will lose themselves for hours in this richly entertaining novel full of dramatic twists and turns. From the spectacular era that bears her name comes the spellbinding story of Elizabeth I – her tragic childhood, her confrontation with Mary, Queen of Scots and her brilliant reign.

17. The young woman is shown in a "shepherdess" hat and white dress, recalling a classical chiton. The background landscape, common in such paintings, seem to indicate the heroine's closeness to nature, to the ordinary joys of life. The painter's colour range – at times as translucent as porcelain, at others muted like mother -of- pearl – is based upon subtle plays of gray and green, light blue and pink.

18. In this picture one is struck by the artist's absolute mastery in portraying natural details, whether the dry, sandy soil of the forest, the clear stream of water in the foreground, the yellow bark and fluffy needles of the pines, or the sense of a bright, clear, calm summer day. The artist managed to create an image familiar to anyone who has seen a Russian forest.

19. Have a good time on the most lively and exciting island in the Caribbean. Relax under a palm tree on the white sandy beaches. Swim in the clear, blue sea. Listen to the bands playing Calypso music. Or get really adventurous and go scuba diving for sunken treasure on the sea bed. Join in the many cultural celebrations we offer, for example the sugar harvest festival.

20. This event is considered the greatest attraction for visitors to the Isle of Man. No definite date can be given, but it is normally held between 5th and 15th July. The Pageant begins at about 8 p.m. First we are given a glimpse of village life in Celtic times. Then suddenly Viking long ships appear and then there are scenes of war. Then Celts and Vikings unite, and the Manx nation is born. The actual Pageant is followed by a grand torchlight procession and firework display.

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READING PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

EUROPEAN INITIATIVES TO PROTECT OCEAN HEALTH

Oceans cover more than 70 percent of the Earth's surface and play a critical role in regulating the planet's climate, providing food, and supporting biodiversity. However, increasing levels of pollution, overfishing, and climate change have severely threatened marine ecosystems. Recognizing the urgent need for action, European countries have implemented a range of measures to protect and restore ocean health.

The European Union (EU) has been at the forefront of global efforts to safeguard marine environments. In 2008, the EU adopted the Marine Strategy Framework Directive (MSFD), which set the ambitious goal of achieving "Good Environmental Status" for all European marine waters by 2020. This comprehensive framework requires member states to develop strategies to monitor, assess, and reduce human impacts on the seas, addressing issues such as pollution, biodiversity loss, and habitat degradation.

Pollution control has been a major focus of European initiatives. Plastic waste, in particular, has attracted significant attention due to its devastating impact on marine life. In 2019, the EU introduced a directive banning single-use plastics, including items such as straws, cutlery, and plates. The legislation also targets fishing gear, one of the largest sources of marine litter, by requiring producers to cover the costs of waste management and cleanup. These measures aim to drastically reduce the volume of plastic entering the ocean and to encourage a shift towards more sustainable materials. Beyond plastics, European nations are also addressing chemical pollution. The Water Framework Directive and the REACH Regulation (Registration, Evaluation, Authorisation and Restriction of Chemicals) establish strict controls over hazardous substances entering waterways. By improving the quality of rivers, lakes, and coastal waters, these efforts indirectly benefit the health of marine ecosystems connected to the continent's major river basins.

Overfishing remains another significant threat to European seas. To tackle this problem, the Common Fisheries Policy (CFP) sets quotas for fish catches based on scientific advice, with the aim of maintaining fish stocks at sustainable levels. The CFP also promotes practices such as selective fishing to reduce bycatch and minimize ecological damage. Marine protected areas (MPAs) have been expanded across Europe, providing safe habitats where vulnerable species can recover and flourish without human interference.

Climate change has introduced additional complexities, affecting ocean temperatures, sea levels, and acidity. European countries have integrated ocean protection into broader climate policies, supporting research into blue carbon ecosystems like seagrasses and mangroves that capture significant amounts of carbon dioxide. Investment in marine renewable energy, including offshore wind and wave energy projects, is also seen as a strategy to transition towards a low-carbon economy while minimizing harm to marine environments.

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Collaboration plays a key role in European ocean governance. Countries bordering shared seas, such as the Baltic Sea, the Mediterranean, and the North Sea, work together through regional organizations like OSPAR and HELCOM to coordinate conservation efforts. Cross-border cooperation ensures that marine protection measures are consistent and effective across ecosystems that do not adhere to political boundaries.

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What was the main goal of the EU's Marine Strategy Framework Directive introduced in 2008?

A) To boost plastic exports to countries outside the EU

B) To promote maritime trade and transport across Europe

C) To improve the environmental condition of European marine waters

D) To enhance fish production through genetic modification

22. In what way does the 2019 EU plastics directive aim to cut down marine pollution?

A) By permitting ocean dumping of exported plastic waste

B) By banning all types of plastic used in packaging

C) By banning single-use plastics and making producers responsible for fishing gear waste

D) By replacing plastic with chemicals across all industries

23. What is the main aim of the Common Fisheries Policy (CFP)?

A) To ban commercial fishing entirely in EU waters

B) To form trade deals with global seafood markets

C) To regulate fishing limits based on scientific data and promote sustainable practices

D) To allow free fishing in protected marine zones

24. How do European climate policies support marine conservation?

A) By investing in offshore fossil fuel extraction

B) By using satellite technology to track ocean movements

C) By protecting blue carbon habitats and promoting ocean-based renewable energy

D) By banning all marine transportation to reduce emissions

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For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. The EU's plastic law includes things like straws and throwaway forks and spoons.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

26. The Water Framework Directive and REACH deal only with pollution in the ocean, not in rivers or lakes.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

27. Marine Protected Areas (MPAs) are made to let weak or endangered sea animals live safely without human disturbance.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

28. Europe's clean energy plans include building wind and wave power systems in the sea.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

29. OSPAR and HELCOM are European groups that focus on fish farms and how fish are raised.

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

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READING PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

PHOTOSYNTHESIS

Photosynthesis is the fundamental biological process through which green plants, algae, and certain bacteria convert light energy into chemical energy. This process is essential not only for the survival of these organisms but also for maintaining life on Earth as a whole. By transforming sunlight into usable energy, photosynthesis supports the entire food chain and plays a vital role in regulating the planet's atmosphere.

At the core of photosynthesis is the ability of chlorophyll, a green pigment found in the chloroplasts of plant cells, to absorb light—primarily in the blue and red wavelengths. When light energy is captured, it initiates a complex series of reactions that result in the production of glucose (a type of sugar) and oxygen. The general equation for photosynthesis is:

$$\mathbf{6CO_2 + 6H_2O + light\ energy \rightarrow C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2.}$$

This means that six molecules of carbon dioxide and six molecules of water, in the presence of light, produce one molecule of glucose and six molecules of oxygen.

Photosynthesis occurs in two main stages: the light-dependent reactions and the light-independent reactions (also known as the Calvin cycle). During the light-dependent stage, sunlight is absorbed by chlorophyll and used to split water molecules into oxygen, protons, and electrons. The oxygen is released into the atmosphere, while the energy from the electrons is stored in molecules called ATP and NADPH. These energy carriers are then used in the Calvin cycle to convert carbon dioxide into glucose through a series of enzyme-controlled steps.

Beyond its biological function, photosynthesis has far-reaching ecological and environmental importance. It is the primary mechanism by which atmospheric carbon dioxide is reduced, thereby helping to regulate global temperatures. In this way, photosynthesis acts as a natural counterbalance to the greenhouse effect, which is driven by excess CO_2 emissions from human activities such as burning fossil fuels and deforestation.

Moreover, the oxygen released during photosynthesis is essential for the respiration of most living organisms. Without a steady supply of oxygen from plants and other photosynthetic organisms, the survival of animals, including humans, would not be possible. Forests, particularly tropical rainforests, are often referred to as the "lungs of the Earth" because of their immense contribution to atmospheric oxygen levels.

Despite its importance, the rate of photosynthesis can be influenced by several factors, including light intensity, carbon dioxide concentration, temperature, and the availability of water. Scientists and agriculturalists have studied these variables extensively in efforts to improve crop yields and optimize food production, particularly in regions affected by climate change.

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As global interest in sustainable energy grows, researchers are also looking into artificial photosynthesis as a way to mimic nature's process of energy conversion. If successful, such technology could one day provide clean fuel alternatives by using sunlight to produce hydrogen or other energy-rich molecules.

*For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than **ONE WORD** and / or **A NUMBER** for each question.*

Photosynthesis starts when chlorophyll takes in mostly **30.** _____ and red light from the sun. During the light-dependent stage, water molecules break down into oxygen, protons, and **31.** _____. The **32.** _____ cycle turns carbon dioxide into glucose by using energy from ATP and NADPH. Rainforests are known as Earth's lungs since they produce a lot of **33.** _____ into the atmosphere.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. What is one major way photosynthesis helps reduce global warming?

A) By lowering global temperatures using leaf surfaces

B) By releasing sunlight into the atmosphere

C) By capturing and removing atmospheric carbon dioxide

D) By increasing the number of chloroplasts in cells

35. What is the writer's purpose in this passage?

A) To describe how humans can survive without plants

B) To explain the process and importance of photosynthesis

C) To promote the benefits of artificial lighting for plants

D) To highlight the use of glucose in industrial fuel systems

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